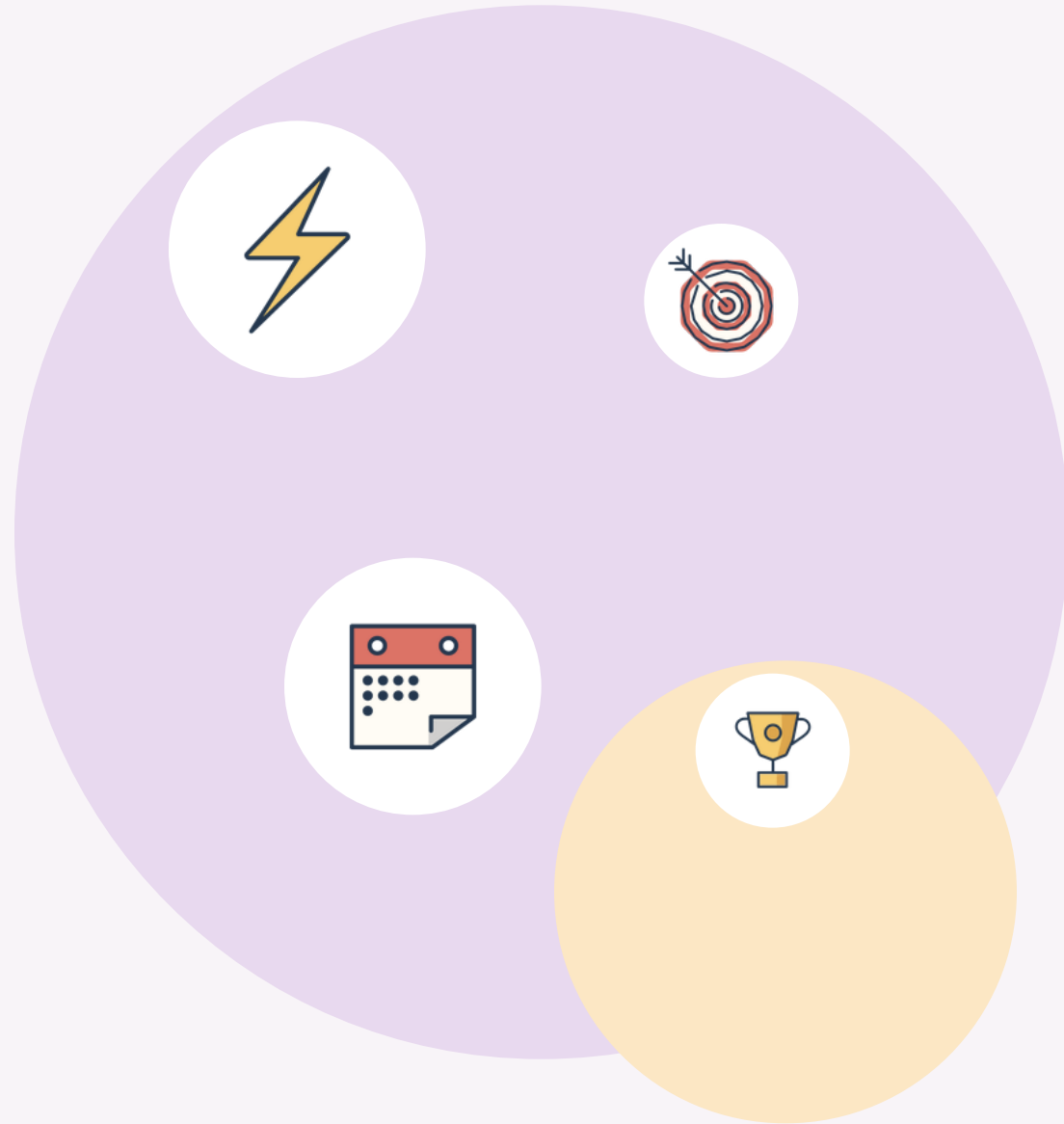


THERAPIST SPOTLIGHT

ADHD: Therapy, Coaching & Skill-Building

The evidence-based supports that help children, teens and adults with ADHD thrive.



ADHD across the lifespan

11.4%

of U.S. children aged 3–17 have
ever been diagnosed with
ADHD

15.5M

U.S. adults currently have
ADHD, about 1 in 16

Sources: CDC analysis of the 2022 National Survey of Children's Health (2024); CDC adult ADHD survey, MMWR (2024).

Therapies that help



Parent training in behavior management

Recommended first for children under 6.



Cognitive behavioral therapy

Adapted CBT for habits, planning and stress.



ADHD coaching

Goal-setting and accountability for planning and follow-through.



School supports

Classroom strategies, 504 plans or IEPs.

Treatment works best combined

- Ages 6+: medication plus behavior therapy
- Teens: add organization and study skills
- Adults: CBT, coaching and workplace supports
- Review the plan as needs change



Under 6? Start with parent training

For young children, guidelines recommend behavior therapy delivered through parents before trying medication.

Build an executive-function routine



Myths and facts



Facts

- ADHD is a neurodevelopmental difference
- It often continues into adulthood
- Therapy and medication can work together
- People with ADHD can focus deeply on interests



Myths

- It's just bad behavior or laziness
- Kids always grow out of it
- Therapy means no medication
- If you can focus sometimes, it isn't ADHD

Key takeaways

- 1 ADHD support spans parent training, therapy, coaching and school plans.
- 2 Combine approaches, and revisit the plan as life changes.
- 3 Executive-function skills can be learned at any age.

This overview is educational and does not replace advice from a qualified clinician.